

City Council February 2, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UgKWHuMt6Jc
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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Common Council

Meeting Date: February 2, 2026

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Common Council was called to order on February 2, 2026, by Council President Jeff Green [00:00:44](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Councilman Dale Basham, Councilman Brandon Garrett, Councilman Jeff Green (President), Councilman Jerry Macintosh, Councilman Brad Mason, Councilwoman Ro Selby, Councilwoman Sarah Powell, and Councilman Aaron Dishman. (Note: Roll call confirms a full council presence during procedural votes).
 - *Presiding Officer:* Council President Jeff Green [00:00:44](#).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was led by Councilman Dale Basher [00:00:55](#).

- An invocation was delivered by Mr. Macintosh [00:01:19](#).
 - **Citizen Recognition:** Councilman Brandon Garrett presented the February Citizen of the Month award to the Southside Neighborhood Association for their efforts in bringing back the "Gus Macker" 3-on-3 basketball tournament to Muncie [00:01:48](#). Councilman Jerry Macintosh also expressed appreciation for city employees, street department snow removal crews, the Muncie Police Department, firefighters, EMTs, and first responders who worked through subzero temperatures and recent snow emergencies [00:08:49](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the previous month's meeting were moved, seconded by Miss Powell [01:05:53](#), and approved by roll call vote [01:11:05](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **[01:27:18](#) Ordinance 1-26: Ordinance for Additional Appropriations (EDIT)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Mayor Dan Ridenour [01:27:43](#).
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Mayor Ridenour presented the ordinance, explaining that a "TBD" notation next to the community center line item was a placeholder until the neighborhood committee was officially established.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input:* Carl Malone (Park Superintendent and Industry Neighborhood President) raised concerns about not being notified of certain neighborhood meetings regarding representatives [01:28:39](#). Other residents, including Mr. Escape [01:31:35](#), Neil Crane [01:33:33](#), and Courtney Marsh [00:54:23](#), asked questions regarding the community center's location and decision-making structure.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Passed Unanimously by roll call vote (9-0) [01:35:46](#).
(Note: Transcript indicates 9 votes recorded/unanimous layout).
- **[01:39:52](#) Ordinance 2-26: Resolution of Approval to Supplement and Amend the Text of the City of Muncie Subdivision Regulations Regarding Article V Improvement and Requirements**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Eileen Swackhammer (Plan Commission) [01:54:22](#).
 - *Deliberation Summary:* The amendment requires developers to preserve natural features and include at least one shade tree per front yard (and per street frontage for corner lots) in new subdivisions, measuring a minimum 2-inch diameter [01:54:39](#).
 - *Item-Specific Public Input:* None.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Passed Unanimously by roll call vote [01:56:05](#).
- **[01:56:20](#) Ordinance 3-26: Ordinance Amending Section 32.39 of the City of Muncie Code of Ordinances (Prerequisites to Action on Ordinance/Resolution)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Councilwoman Sarah Powell / Councilman Brad Mason [01:56:43](#).

- *Deliberation Summary*: This ordinance reorganizes section 32.39 and establishes clearer filing requirements for ordinances and resolutions by council members or attorneys. Extensive debate occurred regarding various amendments (including attempts to integrate the City Controller into the signature/filing workflow). Multiple motions to amend and table were introduced, debated, and subsequently voted down or withdrawn.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input*: Public commenters heavily criticized the procedural complexity and floor amendments as confusing and distracting from the original text [02:09:53, 02:44:07].
 - *Action & Vote Disposition*: After multiple failed amendments and extensive debate, the main body of amendments was voted down, and the item ultimately stalled/did not pass as originally intended during the chaotic procedural sequence [03:16:10](#).
 - **[03:16:54](#) Ordinance 4-26: Ordinance Fixing Maximum Salaries of Each and Every Member of the Muncie Police Department for the Year 2026**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter*: Deputy Police Chief [03:17:32](#) / City Administration.
 - *Deliberation Summary*: Establishes maximum salary caps to keep the department competitive.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input*: Brief questions regarding funding availability and percentage raises were answered by the administration [03:22:12](#).
 - *Action & Vote Disposition*: Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously.
 - **[03:18:26](#) Resolution 1-26: Resolution of Approval for the 2025 Changes to the Official Zone Maps for the City of Muncie**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter*: Planning Department representatives [03:18:51](#).
 - *Deliberation Summary*: Summarized 12 rezonings processed throughout 2025 [03:18:51](#).
 - *Item-Specific Public Input*: None.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition*: Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [03:19:37](#).
 - **[03:19:52](#) Resolution 2-26: Resolution Approving the Collective Bargaining Agreement with the Greg Winners Memorial Fraternal Order of Police Lodge Number 87**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter*: FOP / Police Union Representative [03:20:12](#).
 - *Deliberation Summary*: The representative noted that the agreement keeps Muncie competitive with regional agencies (like Anderson) and highlighted union concessions regarding overtime cost reductions, vacation scheduling restrictions, and uniform provisions [03:20:12](#). Council members confirmed that these changes involved mutual give-and-take [03:21:55](#).
 - *Item-Specific Public Input*: General questions regarding percentage raises and fiscal sustainability [03:22:12](#).
 - *Action & Vote Disposition*: Approved by Voice Vote / Passed Unanimously [03:22:55](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

A lengthy, highly attended general public comment period took place early in the meeting [01:11:25](#), focusing heavily on newly implemented council meeting rules restricting public comment (e.g., moving public comment to the beginning of meetings, shortening speaker times from 3 to 2 minutes, prohibiting comment on ordinance introductions, and initial address collection requirements).

- [00:11:38](#) **Richard Ricker**: Discussed local news, park plan funding relative to the returning Gus Macker tournament, local foundation grants, and the constitutional right to redress government.
- [00:13:58](#) **Susan Dylan**: Speaking as the new Chair of the Muncie Ethics Commission, thanked Dr. Chip Taylor for his work, highlighted the commission's annual report, ethics portal, and the newly launched city contracts transparency portal.
- [00:15:56](#) **Elizabeth Riddle**: Urged passage of Ordinance 03-26, opposed public comment rule changes, and raised concerns about public address requirements exposing residents to harassment.
- [00:19:05](#) **Daisy Dale**: Criticized Council President Jeff Green's newly enacted rules restricting public participation, local government transparency, and online meeting record retention.
- [00:22:10](#) **Rita Falconer**: Criticized the authoritarian nature of the new meeting rules, the timing of public comments, and limitations on speaking during ordinance introductions.
- [00:24:35](#) **Ellen Whitehead**: Expressed concern that moving public comments to the beginning of meetings would cause disorganization and prevent citizens from commenting on developments during meetings.
- [00:26:18](#) **Alex Clubber**: Requested that public comment remain at the end of meetings, urged preserving the 3-minute limit, and asked that local boards post agendas and minutes online.
- [00:28:10](#) **Jerry White**: Voiced concerns over district representation, meeting rules, and the chilling effect of new speech restrictions.
- [00:29:58](#) **Wayne Cape**: Addressed council civility definitions, double standards regarding behavior, and the silencing of public input during ordinance introductions.
- [00:33:11](#) **Melinda Messino**: Thanked organizations for hosting recent community education events and announced the upcoming Black History Month kickoff at Minatrista.
- [00:34:55](#) **Beth Mesner**: Emphasized that freedom of expression is vital to a functioning republic and urged keeping public comments at the end of meetings.
- [00:37:01](#) **Christopher Bilbury**: Argued against home address mandates and raised issues regarding council members failing to respond to constituent emails.
- [00:44:39](#) **Ryan Webb (speaking under an alias initially)**: Objected to restrictions on public comment and suggested modeling sign-up sheets after Delaware County's system.

- **00:47:26 Lynn Thornberg:** Emphasized the historic importance of neighborhood associations bringing local issues directly to the council.
- **00:49:54 Paul Partisana:** Inquired about agency and revitalization options for the former Borg Warner industrial site.
- **00:51:57 Mary Moore:** Critiqued the new meeting rules, comparing them to requiring “clairvoyance” or a “crystal ball” to comment on drafts.
- **00:54:23 Courtney Marsh:** Asked for clarification regarding the “TBD” status of the community center board funding line item.
- **00:60:02 Janetta Presley:** Raised severe safety concerns regarding a city-backed “critical home repairs” program where a recently installed furnace was allegedly installed improperly without inspections and nearly caused a fire.
- **01:02:12 Joseph Souza:** Compared local city council sign-up restrictions unfavorably to state-level committee testimony processes.
- **01:04:24 Chelsea McDaniel:** Criticized the council’s handling of public comment restrictions and urged adherence to constitutional protections.
- **01:06:24 Jackson Franklin:** Noted that council chamber doors were locked during the meeting, restricting public access, and opposed public comment restrictions.
- **01:11:53 Julian Franklin:** Echoed concerns regarding restrictions on public input during ordinance introductions.
- **01:13:03 Cameron Grubbs:** Noted candidate filing deadlines, criticized unilateral rule changes, and called for more effective municipal leadership.
- **01:15:40 Audi (Resident):** Protested locked doors and restrictions on public input, asserting that citizens will continue attending until rules are restored.

*(Additionally, during Committee Reports **01:23:54**, newly appointed members of the Community Center Committee—including Courtney Marsh, Jasmine Taylor, and Judy Hill—spoke about their mission to build a replacement community center for the south side and surrounding neighborhoods).*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Committee appointments were finalized for the EDIT building corporation (Danielle Castle, Judith Hill) **01:21:51** and Bill Go **01:22:42**, alongside the official announcement of the Muncie Community Center advisory committee members representing Morningside, Blaine, Industry, South Central, and Southside neighborhoods **01:24:52**.
 - **Adjournment:** Following the conclusion of all agenda items and collective bargaining votes, a motion for adjournment was made, seconded, and the meeting was officially adjourned **03:23:07**.
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